

# Project Charter Template

## Agile Software Engineering Capstone

Use this charter during project initiation to agree on the project destination before detailed planning and implementation begin. The completed charter should show that the project is needed, feasible for the semester, and a responsible use of the team's available time and resources.

**How to use this template:** Text inside brackets tells you what to write. Replace every bracketed prompt with your team's information before submitting. Keep the charter concise. Put detailed requirements in the Requirements Document and detailed sprint scheduling in the Project Plan.

| Document field               | Team entry                                              |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Project title                | Commerce Bank Personal Finance & Budgeting Assistant    |
| Team name                    | Royal Development                                       |
| Team members                 | Jake Hall, Cesar Giner, Jacob Melookaran, Joshua Webber |
| Project manager or team lead | Cesar Giner                                             |
| Project sponsor              | Shah, Syed Jawad Hussain                                |
| Customer or client           | Commerce Bank                                           |
| Instructor                   | Shah, Syed Jawad Hussain                                |
| Start and target end dates   | September 04, 2026 - December 15, 2026                  |
| Version status and date      | 0.1 Initial Draft, September 25, 2026                   |

## Revision history

| Version   | Date               | Author    | Change and approval                |
|-----------|--------------------|-----------|------------------------------------|
| 0.1       | September 25, 2026 | Royal Dev | Initial draft, Team Approval       |
| [Version] | [Date]             | [Name]    | [What changed and who approved it] |

## 1 Project Purpose and Authorization

### 1.1 Problem or opportunity

There are many people around the world who have trouble with their finances, especially in a time where being strict with money might be more important than ever. The time for people using cash to budget is over and everything has transitioned to a digital world which can be harder than some to adjust to. Only being able to see charged transaction amounts can lead to a loss of confidence and continued avalanche effect with no path to take. A clean, streamlined budget monitoring app with easy to use functionality could help a lot of people to get on the right track.

## 1.2 Project justification

| Decision test | Team explanation                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Evidence or source                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Needed        | Provides users a secure and accessible way to track personal budgets and spending by category with projected savings plans. Also included will be an easy-to-use AI assistant.                                                   | Commerce Bank Full Stack Finances and Budget Tracking Application                                                                                                                                                             |
| Feasible      | We believe that this team has the well-rounded technical expertise to complete this project within scope and requirements. We also have the help of the mentors of our sponsor who can fill the gaps in information we may have. | Team knowledge and skills in front-end, back-end, databases, generative AI, cybersecurity, UI/UX design and more. As well as the assistance of mentors, sponsors, and the course instructor.                                  |
| Optimum       | A budget tracking application allows the team to gain practical experience with a real-world company and employees while also furthering and developing our curriculum in computer science.                                      | We would not have these same resources at our disposal if we were to implement this project on our own or as a group. The collaboration and resources we are privileged to have will help us learn at the highest capability. |

## 1.3 Product vision

For banking customers who struggle with tracking expenses and managing personal finances, the Commerce Bank Personal Finance & Budgeting Assistant is a secure web application that provides robust budgeting tools, expense monitoring, and financial planning to help users gain clear insight into their spending habits.

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## 1.4 Authority to proceed (Sponsor Fill Out)

| Authorization item | Entry                                                                                          |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Decision           | [Approved to proceed / Approved with conditions / Revision required / Not approved]            |
| Conditions         | [List any conditions that the team must satisfy]                                               |
| Authority granted  | [State what the team may begin, such as requirements work, prototyping, and Sprint 1 planning] |

## 2 Stakeholders and Team Authority

Identify everyone who can affect the project or is affected by its outcome. Record their needs and decision authority so the team knows whom to consult

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## 2.1 Stakeholder register

| Stakeholder or group | Interest needs or expectations                                                                            | Decision or contribution                                                                             | Contact or review cadence                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Project sponsor      | Successful, working full-stack capstone application that satisfies given requirements by Commerce Bank    | Approves vision and/or implementation of product                                                     | Commerce Bank                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Customer or client   | Budget and Finance Tracking Bank Application that is fully developed                                      | Provides feedback and acceptance input through mentorship and a semester check-in                    | Rebecca Fantasma<br>Anar Agayev<br>Julio Gracida<br>Clayton Soniker                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Target users         | A budget tracking tool that is intuitive and usable regardless of technical background                    | Participate in informal usability feedback/testing sessions with team members                        | Will reach out to extended social network for quality and feedback                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Instructor           | Course requirements are met and demonstrate agile software engineering practice                           | Clarifies course scope and assesses work                                                             | Shah, Syed Jawad Hussain<br>shs6g7@umsystem.edu                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Student team         | A distinction between responsibilities that need to be carried out on a realistic and achievable timeline | Builds, tests, documents, and demonstrates the usability of a Finance and Budget Tracker Application | <a href="mailto:jmtqv@umkc.edu">jmtqv@umkc.edu</a><br><a href="mailto:cesarqinerkc@gmail.com">cesarqinerkc@gmail.com</a><br><a href="mailto:jwebb9024@gmail.com">jwebb9024@gmail.com</a><br><a href="mailto:jrhtyd@umkc.edu">jrhtyd@umkc.edu</a> |
| [Other stakeholder]  | [Needs and expectations]                                                                                  | [Decision or contribution]                                                                           | [Contact or cadence]                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

## 2.2 Team roles and responsibilities

| Team member | Primary role                               | Charter responsibility                                                                                                      | Decision authority or backup                                                                           |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Jake Hall   | U/UXI Design                               | Setting up charter initial draft                                                                                            | UI/UX design choices (Backup: Cesar)                                                                   |
| Cesar Giner | Project Lead / Front-End Dev               | Defining Project Purpose, Stakeholders Authority, and Project Goals/Features. Setting up a Git-hub repository for documents | Project Organization, Frontend architecture, data integration and user interface (Backup: Jacob, Jake) |
| Jacob       | Back-End Lead                              | Defining Project Purpose, Stakeholders Authority, Milestones                                                                | Backend logic and database schema (Backup: Cesar)                                                      |
| Joshua      | Security Architect / Project Documentation | Organize Project Direction                                                                                                  | Project documentation, and security standards (Backup: Team consensus)                                 |

## 2.3 Decision and escalation rules

Routine development tasks and day-to-day implementation choices are delegated to individual team members, empowering them to drive design and technical problem-solving within their assigned areas. Major project milestones, scope adjustments, and architectural decisions are resolved collaboratively through team-wide consensus. In the event of a persistent deadlock where consensus cannot be reached, the team will consult the course instructor, Syed Jawad Hussain, for guidance and resolve.

## 3 Goals Objectives and High Level Features

Goals describe the desired direction. Objectives make the expected outcomes specific and measurable. Features identify the main functions that deliver value to the client or users.

### 3.1 Project goals

| Goal ID | Goal statement                                                                                                                          | Why it matters                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| G-01    | Provide a fully developed finance and budget tracking application that aids users to budget, track expenses, and analyze their finances | Almost all of banking has transitioned to a digital medium pushing the need for an application users can use as a tool to achieve their financial goals                            |
| G-02    | Deliver a secure, highly usable web application that protects user privacy and maintains regulatory compliance.                         | Ensures that handling sensitive personal financial data does not compromise user trust, while keeping usability high so the software remains accessible without technical barriers |
| G-___   | [Additional goal if needed]                                                                                                             | [Value]                                                                                                                                                                            |

### 3.2 Measurable objectives

| Objective ID | Specific measurable objective             | Target date        | How the team will verify it?(Demo, test result, metric, or approval) |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| OBJ-01       | Complete Initial Draft of Project Charter | September 25, 2026 | Team Approval                                                        |
| OBJ-02       | Define Project Requirements               | October 2, 2026    | Team Approval                                                        |
| OBJ-03       | UML Behavior Design                       | October 2, 2026    | Team Approval                                                        |
| OBJ-___      | [Additional objective]                    | [Date or sprint]   | [Verification method]                                                |

### 3.3 High level features

| Feature ID | Client valued feature                       | Primary user or stakeholder | Priority?( Must / Should / Could) |
|------------|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| F-01       | User Login Authentication and Registration  | User                        | MUST                              |
| F-02       | Budget Dashboard                            | User                        | MUST                              |
| F-03       | User Profile                                | User                        | MUST                              |
| F-04       | Data Visualization(Goal 1)                  | User                        | MUST                              |
| F-05       | Session Persistence Mechanism(Goal 2)       | User                        | MUST                              |
| F-06       | Cloud Hosting and Deployment Infrastructure | User                        | COULD                             |
| F-___      | [Additional feature]                        | [User or stakeholder]       | [Priority]                        |

## 4 Scope Priorities and Deliverables

### 4.1 Scope boundaries

| In scope                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Out of scope                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <u>The project scope</u> includes the design, development, and deployment of a secure, web-based personal finance and budgeting assistant. Core deliverables include user registration and secure authentication, a centralized budgeting dashboard for tracking expenses by category, data visualization tools to monitor spending habits against financial goals, LLM integration, and a robust database integration to manage user data securely, all while incorporating a clean and optimal user interface experience. | <u>The out-of-scope</u> boundaries explicitly exclude real banking connections, real money involvement, and real card data( unless Commerce Bank explicitly updates the brief). Additionally, investment portfolio management, financial payment services, and mobile native applications are some of the boundaries/limitations to maintain a realistic delivery timeline. |

### 4.2 Project priorities

Rank the priorities from 1 to 3. Use each rank once, then explain the tradeoff rule.

| Priority area                   | Rank | Team agreement                                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scope and product value         | 3    | Since schedule is top priority, scope will be managed with non-essential features and optional capabilities being reduced to meet strict capstone deadlines. |
| Schedule and course deadlines   | 1    | Fixed sprint and semester deadlines drive all delivery decisions, so scale of features and objectives will be reflected by realistic deadlines               |
| Quality and technical standards | 2    | The quality and security must remain at an acceptable technical baseline regardless of deadlines and scope of project                                        |

### 4.3 Major deliverables and milestones

| ID   | Milestone or deliverable        | Tangible evidence                               | Target date or sprint | Owner  | Reviewer   |
|------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------|------------|
| M-01 | Project charter approved        | Approved charter                                | Sprint 0              | [Name] | Instructor |
| M-02 | Requirements baseline           | Use cases, FRs, NFRs, and traceability          | [Sprint 1]            | [Name] | [Reviewer] |
| M-03 | Architecture candidate reviewed | Architecture document and decision record       | [Sprint 2]            | [Name] | [Reviewer] |
| M-04 | Midsemester increment           | Working product increment and feedback notes    | [Sprint 3]            | [Name] | [Reviewer] |
| M-05 | Feature complete                | Testable release candidate                      | [Sprint 4]            | [Name] | [Reviewer] |
| M-06 | Final delivery                  | Application, tests, documents, and presentation | [Sprint 5]            | [Name] | [Reviewer] |

## 5 Resources Constraints and Assumptions

### 5.1 Preliminary resource and budget estimate

Estimate resources at a level appropriate for initiation. Student labor can be recorded in person-hours even when no money changes hands.

| Resource                  | Estimated quantity or effort           | Estimated cost           | Source or availability        | Owner  |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------|--------|
| Student effort            | [Total person-hours or hours per week] | \$0 course labor         | [Team availability]           | [Name] |
| Hosting or cloud services | [Plan and expected usage]              | [\$ amount or free tier] | [Provider or course resource] | [Name] |
| Development tools         | [Licenses or services]                 | [\$ amount or free]      | [Source]                      | [Name] |
| Equipment or test devices | [Items needed]                         | [\$ amount or existing]  | [Source]                      | [Name] |
| Other                     | [Resource]                             | [\$ amount]              | [Source]                      | [Name] |

### 5.2 Constraints

| Constraint ID | Limit placed on the product or project                 | Source          | Effect on the team                                                |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| C-01          | Complete the project within the course schedule        | Course calendar | The team must adjust scope before missing a required deadline     |
| C-02          | Use only fabricated financial and card data            | Sponsor brief   | The product cannot connect to real accounts or process real money |
| C-03          | [Technology, policy, security, or staffing limitation] | [Source]        | [Effect]                                                          |
| C-___         | [Additional constraint]                                | [Source]        | [Effect]                                                          |

### 5.3 Assumptions and dependencies

| ID   | Type       | Statement                                                                           | How the team will validate or respond | Owner  | Review date |
|------|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|--------|-------------|
| A-01 | Assumption | [Condition outside the team's direct control that is currently believed to be true] | [How and when it will be checked]     | [Name] | [Date]      |
| D-01 | Dependency | [Service, person, data, decision, or resource required]                             | [Fallback if it is unavailable]       | [Name] | [Date]      |
| [ID] | [Type]     | [Statement]                                                                         | [Validation or response]              | [Name] | [Date]      |

## 6 Success Criteria Risks and Agile Working Agreement

### 6.1 Project success criteria

| Criterion ID | What success means                  | Measure or threshold             | Evidence                          | Reviewer       |
|--------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------|
| SC-01        | [A user or sponsor outcome]         | [Target value or pass condition] | [Demo, test, report, or approval] | [Name or role] |
| SC-02        | [A product quality outcome]         | [Target value or pass condition] | [Evidence]                        | [Reviewer]     |
| SC-03        | [A delivery or stakeholder outcome] | [Target value or pass condition] | [Evidence]                        | [Reviewer]     |

### 6.2 Initial risks and obstacles

| Risk ID | Potential problem                | Likelihood            | Impact                | First response                     | Owner  |
|---------|----------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------|--------|
| R-01    | [Technical or nontechnical risk] | [Low / Medium / High] | [Low / Medium / High] | [Preventive or contingency action] | [Name] |
| R-02    | [Risk]                           | [Rating]              | [Rating]              | [Response]                         | [Name] |
| R-03    | [Risk]                           | [Rating]              | [Rating]              | [Response]                         | [Name] |
| R-___   | [Additional risk]                | [Rating]              | [Rating]              | [Response]                         | [Name] |

### 6.3 Agile working agreement

| Working practice                | Team agreement                                                                   |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sprint length and ceremonies    | [Sprint length, planning, standup, review, and retrospective schedule]           |
| Backlog ownership               | [Who maintains priorities and how sponsor feedback enters the backlog]           |
| Definition of done              | [Minimum code review, testing, documentation, and acceptance conditions]         |
| Communication and response time | [Primary channel, expected response time, and meeting attendance rule]           |
| Scope change                    | [Who may approve a major change and how the charter and backlog will be updated] |
| Conflict or missed commitment   | [Team resolution steps and escalation path]                                      |

## 7 Approval and Submission Check

Approval confirms that the reviewers understand the project purpose, boundaries, expected outcomes, and initial authority. It does not freeze the entire backlog. Record approved charter changes in the revision history.

### 7.1 Review decisions

| Reviewer                 | Role                 | Decision           | Conditions or comments                                                                         | Date               |
|--------------------------|----------------------|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| [Name]                   | Project sponsor      | [Approve / Revise] | [Conditions or comments]                                                                       | [Date]             |
| Shah, Syed Jawad Hussain | Instructor           | [Approve / Revise] | [Conditions or comments]                                                                       | [Date]             |
| Cesar Giner              | Student Project Lead | Team Approval      | The team has reviewed and approved the finalization of the Project Charter Initial Draft(v0.1) | September 25, 2026 |

### 7.2 Signatures

| Name and role                     | Signature   | Date               |
|-----------------------------------|-------------|--------------------|
| [Project sponsor]                 |             |                    |
| [Instructor]                      |             |                    |
| Cesar Giner, Project Lead         | Cesar Giner | September 25, 2026 |
| [Additional approver if required] |             |                    |

### 7.3 Version Notes/Remarks:

**Version:** v0.1 - Initial Draft

**Notes:**

- **Section 1.4:** To be completed by whom is formally authorized
- **Sections 4.3 through 6.3:** Milestones, deliverables, resource estimates, constraints, success criteria, and agile workflows will be iteratively refined and updated as project analysis and requirements mature.

### 7.4 Final submission checklist

- [ ] The problem or opportunity is clear and does not begin with a predetermined solution.
- [ ] The charter explains why the project is needed, feasible, and a responsible use of resources.
- [ ] Stakeholders, team responsibilities, and decision authority are clear.
- [ ] Goals, measurable objectives, and high level features agree with one another.
- [ ] In scope and out of scope boundaries can guide backlog decisions.
- [ ] Milestones name tangible deliverables, target dates, owners, and reviewers.
- [ ] Constraints, assumptions, dependencies, success criteria, and initial risks are recorded.
- [ ] The agile working agreement explains how the team will plan, review, test, communicate, and handle changes.
- [ ] Every bracketed prompt has been replaced or removed before submission.

[ ] The version, date, author list, and approval decisions are current.

**Recommended filename:** TeamName\_ProjectCharter\_v1.0.docx